Lipfty - How to play

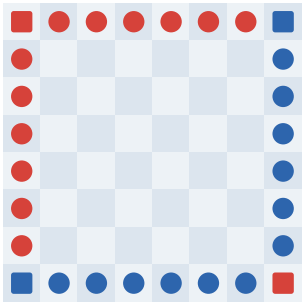
Rules for Lipfty 16.0.4 | Matches and corner counters | 18 October 2026

A two-player strategy game with shared pieces. Neither player owns a colour. Usually your opponent chooses your piece; you decide how to use it.

1. Setup

Use an 8 x 8 board. The inner 6 x 6 is the playing area and starts completely empty. There is no Opening Four.

Put 24 ordinary round pieces, 12 Red and 12 Blue, on the six non-corner cells of each outside edge in any order. Put one squarish win counter at each physical corner: two Red and two Blue in total. These four counters never enter the playing area. Use other distinct colours if preferred. In Settings choose Single game, Best of 3 or Best of 5 (default). Choose the first starter; starters alternate after each game in a match, including draws.



Empty inner 6 x 6

24 ordinary pieces

4 squarish win counters

Never enter play

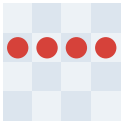
2. Winning and game versions

Learning: Place only; four of one colour in a horizontal, vertical or diagonal line wins.

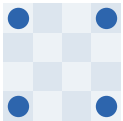
Easy: Place, Move and Jump; the same line wins apply.

Standard: Easy plus four of one colour at the corners of an axis-aligned square, tight or spaced. Its sides must be equal and parallel to the board edges. Intervening spaces need not be empty.

The player completing the pattern wins, whatever its colour. Check after EVERY placement, Move, Jump and redeployment. A win ends the game immediately, cancelling any remaining compulsory placements. All inner squares can count towards wins from the start.



Line: all versions



Square: Standard

3. Normal turns

The opponent selects an ordinary reserve piece for the player taking the turn. Corner counters cannot be chosen as playing pieces. If only one reserve colour is available, the app selects it automatically; the player still chooses their action.

Place: put the selected piece on any empty inner square.

Move (Easy / Standard): move an unpinned board piece of the handed colour one adjacent square in any of eight directions to an empty square. Hold the selected reserve piece for the consequence. A Move needs another ordinary reserve piece besides the held piece.

Jump (Easy / Standard): jump an unpinned piece of the handed colour over one adjacent opposite-colour, unpinned piece into the empty square beyond. One jump only. Keep the jumped piece for redeployment.

You cannot Move or Jump the exact piece protected by the opponent's previous Move or Jump. After an ordinary placement, choose the next ordinary piece for your opponent.

4. First placement: Accept / Take position

After the first ordinary placement, the other player decides: Accept and play next, or Take position and make the original starter play next. The placed piece stays where it is. Colours remain shared.

Click the flashing first placement to Take position. Click an available ordinary reserve to Accept and select that exact piece for your next turn. The Accept button uses the normal starter-chooses route.

5. After a Move

If the Move did not win:

1. The mover holds the originally selected ordinary reserve piece.

2. The opponent chooses and places another ordinary reserve piece, of either available colour. The held piece is unavailable.

3. The mover places the exact held piece.

4. Normal play resumes with the opponent taking the next turn.

With only one ordinary reserve piece left, Move is unavailable: there is no second ordinary piece for its consequence. Place or an otherwise legal Jump remains available. Never use a corner counter to fill the sequence.

Worked example: you are handed Red and Move an ordinary Red board piece. Your opponent chooses Blue from the ordinary reserve and places it; you then place your held Red. Both consequence actions are Place only.

Then TWO placements

Opponent first; mover second

Hold the selected reserve until its placement.

6. After a Jump

If the Jump did not win:

1. The opponent chooses between the exact held reserve piece and the removed jumped piece, and places one.

2. The jumper places the other exact piece.

3. Normal play resumes with the opponent taking the next turn.

Worked example: you are handed Red and Jump a Red board piece over Blue. Your opponent may place the held Red or removed Blue; you place the other. No corner counter is used.

Jumped pieces are redeployed, never permanently captured. Consequence actions are Place only. After a Move or Jump, the moving piece is protected through the consequence and the opponent's following normal turn.

Then TWO placements

Opponent first; mover second

Jumped Blue is redeployed.

7. Matches, counters and draws

Single game: first to one win. Best of 3: first to two wins. Best of 5: first to three wins. Stop as soon as either player reaches the target.

After the first win, the winner takes any squarish corner counter, choosing that colour as their win-counter colour. The opponent then collects the other colour. After later wins, take a remaining counter of your own colour. The computer takes an eligible counter automatically. Counter colours track wins only: both players still use either ordinary piece colour.

Taken counters disappear from their corners. Click Next game to continue; its inner board and 24 ordinary reserves start afresh. Counter ownership and the score remain. The Accept / Take position choice is retained for every game's first placement; it does not exchange scores or counter ownership.

Worked match: Alice wins and chooses a Red corner counter. Ben collects Blue when he wins. At 2-2, all four counters have been taken; game 5 decides the match. No fifth counter is needed. Likewise a 3-0 winner needs only their two physical counters; the display records the third win.

Alice 2 - 2 Ben: deciding game

All four counters taken

Next win makes 3 - 2: no fifth counter needed.

Move and Jump remain available with one ordinary reserve colour left, subject to their normal legal requirements. Finish every compulsory placement unless a win ends the game. With all ordinary reserves used and consequences complete, no winning pattern means a draw. An impossible compulsory placement is also a draw.

Draws award no counter or match point. Replay the same numbered game; the starting player still alternates. Click Replay game. New match (New game in Single game mode) clears the score and resets all four counters. Applying Settings also starts a new match.

8. Clock, highlights and Undo

Optional clock: time expiry loses. Available pieces pulse in their colour; the selected reserve flashes. Dots mark legal placements and Move/Jump destinations. Select a board piece again to return to placement. Animations off uses steady highlights.

Undo restores position, clock, statistics, match score, counter colours and taken counters. It returns to a human decision against the computer. Each new game resets clocks; statistics count individual games. Undo cannot cross a completed game after Next game.

Play: https://blarm1959.github.io/Lipfty-App/